

HIGHWAY TO HEAVEN
Zanskar Highway, an under-construction road in Leh, Sept. 23, 2021

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Building roads and highways picked up speed in India in the 2000s. Now, the country has the second largest road network in the world, after the US

By ***Shwweta Punj***

At 75 years young, India boasts of a formidable road network—the second largest in the world—spanning 63 lakh km (Basic Road Statistics in India report, 2018-19). At the time of Independence, the country's road network, which includes state and national highways (NH), and rural roads—was barely 4 lakh km. The pace of construction of roads and highways, according to government data, has gone up by 300 per cent in the past seven years. Now, India has 4.87 km of road for every 1,000 people.